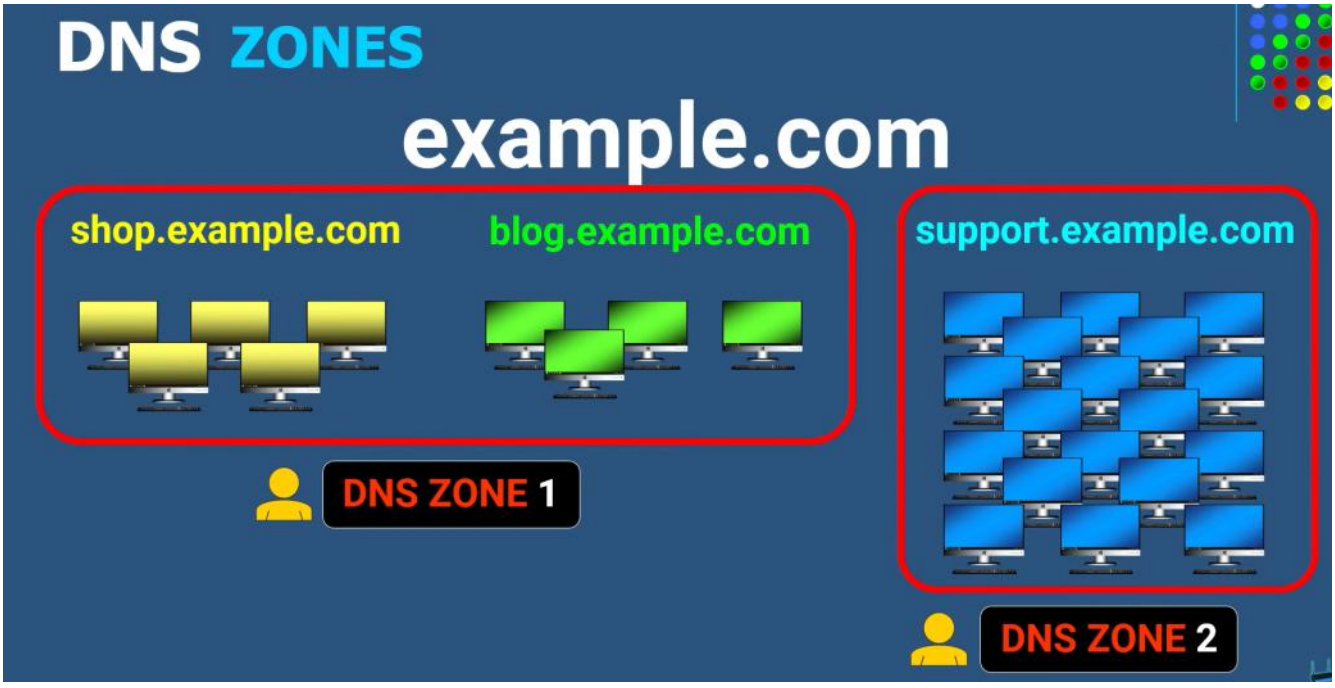
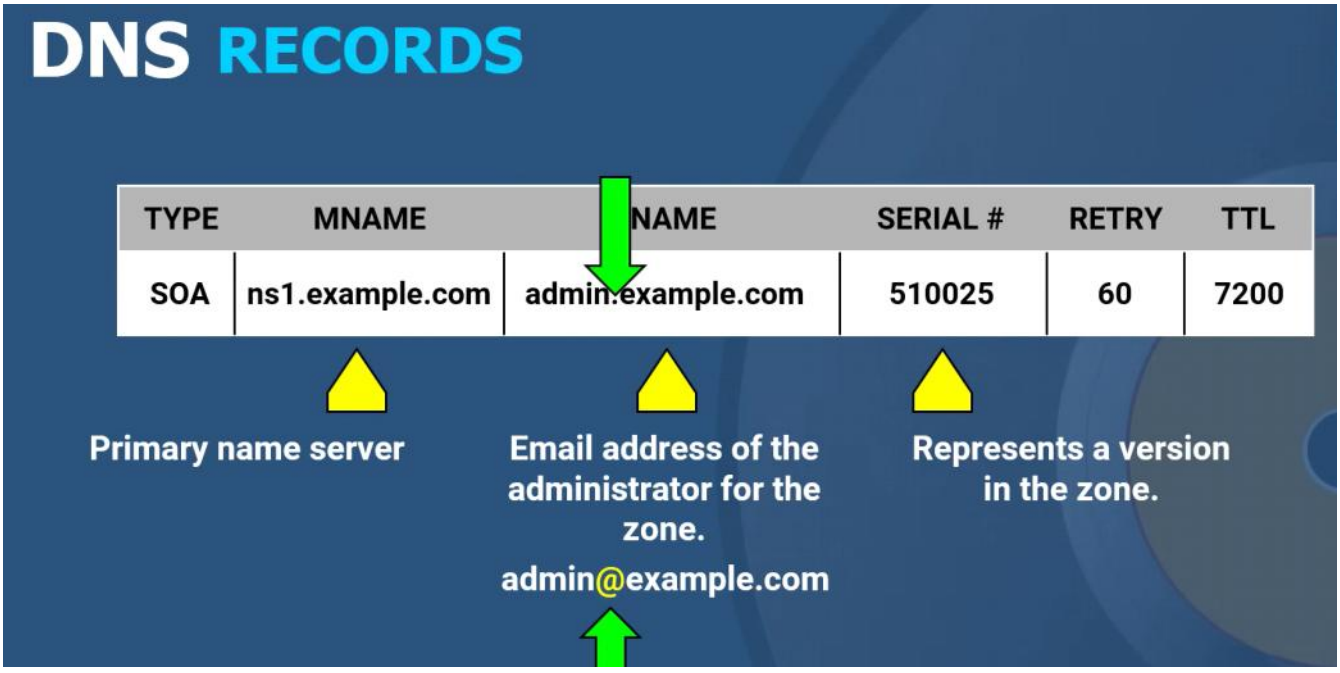
DNS Records Part 4

Wednesday, February 25, 2026 9:30 PM

SOA record





The SOA record, or start of authority record, stores administrative information about a DNS zone. A DNS zone is a section of a domain name space where a specific administrator has control. DNS zones are created for manageability, allowing a domain name space to be divided into different sections, with each zone having its own DNS zone file that contains an SOA record.

An SOA record includes:

MNAME: The primary name server.
RNAME: The email address of the administrator for the zone, where a dot represents the "@" symbol.
Serial number: A number that represents a version in the zone; it changes when an update occurs, signaling secondary servers to update.